

Ideation Phase

Empathy Map Canvas: Understanding the Stakeholder Experience

Attribute	Project Information
Project Title	Auto Ticket Classification using Flow Designer
Phase / Stage	1. Ideation Phase
Document Title	Empathy Map Canvas
Platform & Scope	ServiceNow Utah / Vancouver / Washington DC (Global Scope)
Team ID	SWTID-2026-4988

1. Executive Overview

Empathy mapping is an essential human-centered design technique that bridges technical system architecture and human user reality. In this project, we analyze two distinct stakeholder personas: Persona A (The Academic Caller - Teacher/Student) and Persona B (The IT Helpdesk Technician). By mapping what they think, feel, say, do, hear, and see, we establish clear design guardrails for our ServiceNow Flow Designer automation.

2. Persona A: Academic Caller (Student & Teacher)

Empathy Dimension	Stakeholder Observation & Empirical Insight
Who are we empathizing with?	Students and Teachers in a campus environment encountering daily hardware, software, network, or account obstacles.
What do they need to DO?	Submit a quick ticket with minimum friction (just Caller name and Short Description) and receive immediate confirmation that IT is handling it.
What do they SEE?	Red error screens on classroom projectors, disconnected Wi-Fi symbols on laptops, "Account Locked" warnings on student portals, and long queues at the IT desk.
What do they SAY?	"The library Wi-Fi dropped again!", "The projector in Room 204 won't turn on before class", "I forgot my portal password and have a test due!"
What do they DO?	Quickly type a frantic summary into the helpdesk form, refresh their inbox repeatedly to see if someone replied, and complain to peers if no confirmation arrives.
What do they HEAR?	Peers saying "IT takes forever to answer tickets", administrators urging teachers to stay on digital curriculum schedule, and notifications dinging on their phones.
PAINS (Frustrations & Fears)	Lengthy technical forms with dropdowns they don't understand; fear of disrupted classes; uncertainty about whether IT actually received their request.
GAINS (Wants & Needs)	A clean form requiring only a short issue description; instant email confirmation with ticket ID; prompt resolution by the right specialist.

3. Persona B: IT Helpdesk Specialist (First-Line Support)

Empathy Dimension	Stakeholder Observation & Empirical Insight
Who are we empathizing with?	Campus IT Helpdesk Agents responsible for triaging incoming incidents, assigning categories, and routing to Tier 2 technicians.
What do they need to DO?	Process hundreds of tickets per day accurately, route network issues to the Network Team, hardware to Field Support, and access tickets to Identity Management.
What do they SEE?	An unorganized backlog of 50+ unassigned tickets every morning; inconsistent category selections; frantic teachers standing at the support counter.
What do they SAY?	"90% of tickets clearly say Wi-Fi, projector, password, or slow computer in the subject line! Why am I manually clicking dropdowns for each one?"
What do they DO?	Read short descriptions, select Category, wait for subcategories to populate, select Subcategory, save the form, and manually draft acknowledgement emails.
What do they HEAR?	Management pushing for shorter Mean Time to Acknowledge (MTTA); faculty complaining about responsiveness; Tier 2 complaining about misrouted tickets.
PAINS (Frustrations & Fears)	Repetitive strain from mindless manual data entry; human classification mistakes when rushing; being blamed for communication delays.
GAINS (Wants & Needs)	Automatic categorization at the point of creation; automated notification dispatch to callers; standardized data integrity.

4. Architectural Synthesis & Translation to ServiceNow Features

Empathy Map Insight	Target ServiceNow Architectural Feature	Operational Impact
Callers do not understand technical IT categories	Form Designer: Only expose Caller and Short Description as mandatory; hide Category during submission.	Reduces submission time from 90 seconds to under 15 seconds.
Callers experience anxiety about ticket receipt	Flow Designer Action: Send Email notification to Caller immediately upon record creation.	100% immediate acknowledgment within 2 seconds of ticket creation.
Agents spend excessive time on repetitive keyword triage	Flow Designer: Conditional evaluation on Short Description (WiFi, Projector, Password, Slow Computer).	Eliminates 85% of manual triage overhead.
Incorrect category/subcategory pairings degrade reporting	Dictionary Entry: Enable dependent choice logic on Subcategory field dependent on Category.	Guarantees 100% data consistency and eliminates invalid data pairings.